

STEVE CUMMINS

Principal / Chief Marketer, Solent Strategies

SESSION 7 • FRIDAY, SEPTEMBER 25 • 12:30 PM ET • 30 MINUTES • VIRTUAL • PRESENTATION, THEN Q&A

Marketing that Maps the Customer Journey

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ABOUT THIS SESSION

Every founder is told to do marketing, and everyone they ask has a different opinion. Steve Cummins, a fractional CMO with more than 20 years in B2B marketing, walks the customer journey stage by stage and shows which tactics actually belong at each one. The session closes on the one or two things this cohort should do well rather than trying to cover every base.

WHAT YOU WILL LEAVE WITH

- Define the goal of your marketing, then match tactics to each stage
- What has to be in place before you spend: a clear message, a defined reachable audience
- Do one or two things well rather than covering every base

ABOUT STEVE

Steve helps growing businesses punch above their weight, working with companies who are ready to take marketing seriously but are not ready for a full time CMO. That means developing the right message, reaching a broader audience, and executing a marketing plan tailored for their business. Steve has an engineering background and more than 20 years experience in global B2B marketing with name-brand companies and feisty start-ups. He also coaches and mentors marketers and teams of one.

WHAT WE NEED FROM YOU

Your deck	Final version 72 hours before the session, so we can prep and promote.
Sync call	15 minutes with us the week before. We send the invite.
Calendar hold	Lands in your inbox as soon as you confirm the date.

TO SETTLE ON THE SYNC CALL

- Which one or two tactics we close on, so the room leaves with a decision
- How much of the 30 minutes you want to keep for questions
- Whether your one-pager and eBook go into the cohort resource library under your name

ERIC SCHMALZBAUER

Former co-founder & CEO, Prospective

SESSION 2 • MONDAY, SEPTEMBER 14 • 12:30 PM ET • 30 MINUTES • VIRTUAL • FIRESIDE CHAT

B2B: from idea > funding > failure

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ABOUT THIS SESSION

Founders hear success stories constantly and almost never a first-hand account of the other outcome. Eric Schmalzbauer takes us through the whole arc of his venture-backed B2B startup: the idea, the fundraising, building the team, and the decision to wind it down. He covers what worked, what he would change next time, and what he would do more of. A candid conversation rather than a polished talk.

WHAT YOU WILL LEAVE WITH

- Tangible examples of what worked and what did not inside a venture-backed startup
- As a founder you always have to be selling, in some form
- Honest acknowledgement that the job is very lonely

ABOUT ERIC

Eric Schmalzbauer is a technology executive, founder, and venture partner across product strategy, data platforms, and go-to-market execution. He is the now former co-Founder and CEO of Prospective, the team behind the open-source Perspective project, building high-performance tools for interactive data analytics. Eric previously held senior leadership roles across financial market infrastructure and enterprise technology. As a Venture Partner at REFASHIOND Ventures, he advises early-stage founders on product-market fit, fundraising, and scaling.

WHAT WE NEED FROM YOU

No deck needed	It is a fireside. We drive with questions.
Sync call	15 minutes with us the week before. We send the invite.
Calendar hold	Lands in your inbox as soon as you confirm the date.

TO SETTLE ON THE SYNC CALL

- What you are comfortable naming out loud: numbers, timelines, the decision to close
- The three questions you wish someone had asked you at the start, which become the run of show
- Who conducts the fireside with you, and how much time we leave for founder questions

JULIA KAHKY

VP Operations, Tailsight

SESSION 5 • MONDAY, SEPTEMBER 21 • 12:30 PM ET • 30 MINUTES • VIRTUAL • PRESENTATION, THEN Q&A

From startup to dissolution: a post-mortem

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ABOUT THIS SESSION

Everything online is about how companies succeed. Julia Kahky takes the other route and walks through the post-mortem of a startup that closed, specifically what she learned selling software to enterprise customers and into highly regulated markets. Expect specifics on the problems worth avoiding early, product-market fit, and how long sales cycles really take.

WHAT YOU WILL LEAVE WITH

- Problems to avoid early on
- Product-market fit
- Sales cycles

ABOUT JULIA

Julia Kahky is VP of Operations at a software company in the aviation industry, with prior experience as a chief of staff and in financial technology and operations in sports media. She started her career in finance and has worked across Fortune 15 companies, 500-person companies, and startups, with experience spanning finance, operations, marketing, revenue operations, and HR.

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TO SETTLE ON THE SYNC CALL

- How each takeaway becomes something a founder can act on the following Monday
- How much of the 30 minutes you want to keep for questions
- Where The Atrium and your AI tools list fit in the cohort resource library